

IDEATION PHASE

Team ID : NM2025TMID03763

Project Title : Calculating Family Expenses using ServiceNow Administrator

Ideation Phase: “Calculating Family Expenses Using ServiceNow”

1. Problem Statement

Managing family expenses can be complex and time-consuming, often relying on spreadsheets or manual tracking. There is a need for a centralized, automated system that tracks, categorizes, and reports expenses — potentially leveraging ServiceNow’s workflow automation and reporting capabilities.

2. Objectives

- Automate tracking and categorization of family expenses.
- Provide dashboards for monthly/annual expense summaries.
- Enable alerts for budget thresholds or unusual spending.
- Integrate with external sources (bank APIs, receipts, etc.) if possible.
- Promote transparency and shared financial planning among family members.

3. Target Users

- **Primary:** Families or household members sharing financial responsibilities.

- **Secondary:** Financial planners or advisors managing multiple households.

4. Key Questions for Ideation

- How can ServiceNow be used as a personal finance management tool?
- What data inputs will be needed (manual entry, API integrations, receipts)?
- How can workflows automate expense approvals, limits, or notifications?
- What types of visualizations or dashboards would be most useful?
- How can security and privacy of financial data be maintained?

5. Idea Generation

Idea	Description	Benefits	Challenges
Expense Logging App	A custom ServiceNow app where family members submit expenses via forms	Simple, traceable	Requires manual data entry
Budget Workflow Automation	Workflow that triggers notifications when spending exceeds defined limits	Prevents overspending	Needs configurable thresholds
Expense Categorization Engine	Auto-classify expenses by type (groceries, utilities, etc.)	Simplifies reporting	Needs categorization logic

Monthly Reports & Dashboards	Visual analytics in Performance Analytics or Dashboards	Clear insights	Data visualization setup
Integration with Banking APIs	Pull transaction data automatically	Real-time expense tracking	API access & security concerns
AI Expense Insights	Use predictive analytics to forecast future expenses	Smarter planning	Requires additional AI setup

6. Proposed Features

- **Custom Tables:** Expense Record, Expense Category, Family Member, Budget Threshold
- **Forms & Catalog Items:** Submit new expense, view expense history
- **Workflows:** Budget approval, threshold alerts
- **Dashboards:** Monthly summary, category breakdown, trend analysis
- **Notifications:** When spending exceeds set limits
- **Security:** Role-based access control (e.g., parents vs children)

7. Evaluation Metrics

- Accuracy of expense categorization
- User adoption rate
- Reduction in manual tracking effort
- Budget compliance improvement

- User satisfaction feedback

8. Next Steps

1. Conduct stakeholder interviews (families, planners).
2. Prioritize features for MVP (minimum viable product).
3. Create mockups of expense submission and dashboard UI.
4. Define data model and workflow logic in ServiceNow.
5. Proceed to **Concept Development** phase.